JDA CORPORAL PUNISHMENT

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Policy Level: 3
Classification: 12
Descriptor Code: JDA
Descriptor Term: CORPORAL PUNISHMENT
Effective Date: 5/14/2002
Description: MISSION: Reasonable discipline may include the administration of corporal punishment to a student provided the following guidelines are met.

Principals and assistant principals, in order to maintain proper control and discipline of students under their care and supervision, may, in the exercise of sound discretion, administer corporal punishment on students subject to the following requirements:

1. Corporal punishment may not be excessive or severe.
2. Corporal punishment shall never be used as a first line of punishment for misbehavior unless the student is informed beforehand that specific behavior could occasion its use.
3. The principal or assistant principal must contact the parent before administering corporal punishment.
4. Corporal punishment must be administered by a principal or an assistant principal in the presence of a witness who shall be a principal, assistant principal, or a designated member of the faculty. The student and the witness must be informed (in the presence of each other) by the principal or assistant principal of the reason for the punishment before the punishment is administered. Such punishment must be administered in the privacy of an office.
5. The principal or assistant principal who administers corporal punishment must provide the student's parent, upon request, a written explanation of the reason for the punishment and the name of the witness who was present.

Corporal punishment shall not be administered to a student whose parent or legal guardian has filed with the principal, upon the enrollment of the student in a school, a statement requesting that corporal punishment not be administered to the child until the parental statement is revoked.

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